



Established in Germany in 1934, The Blue Card's sole purpose was to provide financial assistance to Jews fleeing from that country's growing persecution. It was re-established in the United States in 1939, to continue aiding refugees escaping from the Nazi horror. Today, it is the only organization in the United States whose sole mission is to aid needy Holocaust survivors by providing cash assistance. The Blue Card offers its invaluable help to Holocaust survivors through a variety of vital programs.

**Description of The Blue Card's Programs**

**1. Claims Conference Emergency Cash Assistance Program – One time grant assistance for emergency needs including:**

- Housing and related costs, such as late payments to prevent eviction or homelessness or shut-off of utilities

- Emergency relocation
- Food purchases
- Medical and dental care, including medical equipment, not otherwise covered by insurance
- Essential clothing and footwear
- Purchase and repair of essential major and minor appliances

**2. Claims Conference In-Home Care Services**

- Health service provided in the survivors' homes to promote, maintain, or restore health or lessen the effects of illness and disability. The purpose of the program is to ensure safe and independent living.
- Claims Conference In-Home Care Service Program for underserved survivors, meaning specifically those residing in remote areas and who are outside of the catchment areas of Claims Conference grantees.
- The Emergency Cash Assistance Program and the In-Home Care Services Program is funded by The Conference on Jewish Material Claims Against Germany.

**3. Emergency Prevention Programs:**

- Monthly Stipend - supports the most poverty-stricken survivors with monthly checks.
- Telephone Emergency Response System - provides the system to Holocaust survivors who do not have the financial resources to pay for installation, service, and maintenance.

**4. Health and Wellbeing Programs:**

- Fighting Cancer Together - offers aid to survivors battling cancer. Assistance is available for transportation to appointments, medical co-pays, nutrition and emotional support.
- Vitamins - provides survivors with multivitamins, minerals, and supplements, and liquid meals.
- Jewish Holiday - provides financial support for the High Holidays, Hanukkah and for Passover, giving survivors the financial means to have a happier holiday season.
- Mazel Tov Birthday - provides survivors with a card on their birthday. Receiving a birthday card means a great deal to survivors who lost their entire families during the war.

- Summer Vacation - Survivors are provided with handicapped-accessible accommodations, transportation, scheduled meals, and a well-planned itinerary, making the program structured, safe, and group-oriented.
- Bring a Smile - provides additional support for terminally ill Holocaust survivors. The program essentially grants survivors their final wish.

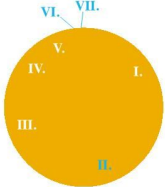
**5. Educational and Outreach Programs:**

- Person-Centered, Trauma-Informed Training for Dental and Medical professionals working with Holocaust survivors - provides sensitivity training to medical and dental profession working with Holocaust survivors.
- Nutrition Guidance - Educates Survivors on proper nutrition.
- Hospital Visitation - offers volunteer visits to hospitalized Holocaust survivors who need guidance and emotional support.

In 2017, The Blue Card distributed \$3,406,854 to destitute Holocaust survivors in the United States; below is the breakdown of that number.

|       |                                      |             |
|-------|--------------------------------------|-------------|
| I.    | Homecare Program                     | \$1,280,184 |
| II.   | Emergency Cash Assistance Program    | \$805,233   |
| III.  | Monthly Assistance Program           | \$650,000   |
| IV.   | Telephone Emergency Response Program | \$352,328   |
| V.    | Jewish Holiday Program               | \$159,109   |
| VI.   | Mazel Tov Birthday Program           | \$100,000   |
| VII.  | Summer Vacation Program              | \$60,000    |
| Total |                                      | \$3,406,854 |

The Blue Card's Clients  
Across the United States



# THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR



5779

**THE BLUE CARD** is a charitable organization aiding Holocaust survivors since 1934. It is dedicated to the support of European Jewish survivors and their descendants in this country, who still suffer from the aftereffects of Nazi persecution, are sick or emotionally unstable, have been unable to achieve economic independence, or have lost it through sickness or old age; in many cases the Holocaust has deprived them of family. The Blue Card's activities aren't duplicated by any other Jewish welfare agencies. During the year 2017, The Blue Card distributed close to \$3.3 million. This brings the grant total since The Blue Card's inception to nearly \$40 million.

**THE BLUE CARD** continues to receive four-star ratings from Charity Navigator, a distinction awarded to only four percent of all charities. The Blue Card is Better Business Bureau (BBB) accredited.

**THE BLUE CARD** mirrors the social conscience of our community. We hope it will be important to you, and that you will remember it in your last will. Your contribution is fully tax deductible.

**THE BLUE CARD** has been publishing this calendar for its friends and friends-to-be for more than 50 years in order to remind them, throughout the year, that there is an organization which is always ready to render assistance to our neediest.

**PLEASE SEE** the inside back cover of this calendar for more information about The Blue Card.

A copy of the most recent financial report may be obtained from The Blue Card, Inc., 171 Madison Ave. Suite 1405, New York, NY 10016.

Front cover: The synagogue at Siegen, Germany, burning on the morning of November 10, 1938.

Back cover: A Jewish merchant sweeps up glass following Kristallnacht.

## INTRODUCTION

This year marks the 80th anniversary of Kristallnacht, the "night of broken glass," which took place on November 9 and 10, 1938. During those days of extreme violence by the German state, Jews in Germany and Austria were accosted in their dwellings by storm troopers, police and others. Many were beaten, rounded up or taken to concentration camps. Some were killed. Jewish-owned businesses were smashed and in many cases looted, and many hundreds of synagogues were destroyed.

(The term Kristallnacht is not universally accepted, as some feel it glosses over the horrors of those days. But we use it here because it is universally known and in very wide use among Jewish and non-Jewish sources.) Of course, Kristallnacht did not take place in a vacuum, but rather was something that had been planned, awaiting only an excuse to proceed. In this calendar, we trace some of what led up to it, and also some of the immediate aftermath.

Kristallnacht was a watershed. Although Jews had previously faced increasingly severe restrictions and official discrimination, and there was significant violence along with incarceration in concentration camps, never before had there been that level of harm done or such a degree of organization to it. It can be considered the start of the Holocaust and the crossing of the line between persecution and genocide.

For my own parents, Kristallnacht was the point at which they realized they had to leave Germany without further delay. At 1:00 a.m. on November 10, storm troopers came to their apartment building in Nuremberg. There were three apartments, each on its own floor. The elderly gentleman living on the floor above my parents' was severely beaten. The man living on the floor below was taken to the Dachau concentration camp. By sheer happenstance, my parents were not harmed and no damage was done to their apartment other than the smashing of one ashtray; the troopers also confiscated their prayer books.

That day and the night of November 10, my father was sheltered by the Gentile superintendent of the building

## THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR

For 5779 (2018-2019 C.E.)

ITS THEME:

### KRISTALLNACHT, ITS ANTECEDENTS AND EFFECTS

Published by

**THE BLUE CARD, Inc.®**

Serving needy Jewish Holocaust survivors since 1939

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5779

and his wife. (Women were for the most part not considered to be in immediate danger at that time, so my mother remained in my parents' apartment.) On November 10, an employee of my father's business bought him a train ticket to Strasbourg, France. My father had the ability only to flee because a few weeks earlier his passport, which had been confiscated by the Nazis, was returned to him in the mail through some miraculous administrative error.

The morning of November 11, my mother drove my father to the train station. He waited until the SS men who were patrolling the station looked the other way, then jumped on the train. My parents didn't know if they would ever see each other again.

My father crossed the border safely into France. But my mother was in a desperate situation. She could not get her passport and exit permit without paying the *Reichsfluchtsteuer* ("Reich flight tax"), but could not pay the tax without selling my father's family's business. However, she couldn't sell the business because two different Nazi-related parties were squabbling over it. In the end, she signed the business over to the Nazi party for no compensation and was able to leave for France on March 30, 1939.

So Kristallnacht very much shaped my family's fate, and they owed their escape to good luck. Many others were not so fortunate. And as we think about Kristallnacht, we must also think about all the other places in the world where pogroms continue to take place, and about the fate of the world's refugees.

— Ralph Hammelbacher

This year's edition was edited by Ralph Hammelbacher. Hella Hammelbacher created the original design, which was ably realized by Jacqueline Enrique.



A 13th-century depiction of Jews in Germany.

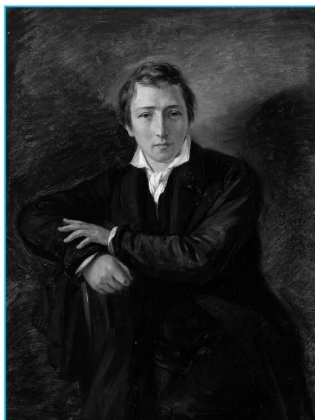
The first Jews in what is today Germany arrived there as early as the 3rd century C.E., most likely having come from Rome. (Jews were known to have been in Rome since at least 139 B.C.E.) In 321 C.E., the emperor Constantine I sent a letter to Cologne agreeing that Jews be allowed to serve in the town's senate — an indication that the Jewish community there was prosperous and well established, since the financial burdens of such a position were considerable.

The ensuing centuries saw some periods when Jews were allowed to live in comparative freedom, but many more when Jews were persecuted. Over the centuries, hundreds of thousands were killed in massacres. At other times, there were restrictions on where Jews could live and which occupations they were allowed to practice, and often Jews were unfairly taxed.

So while the origins of Nazi actions toward the Jews were complex, they were rooted in many centuries of anti-Semitism.

| Elul 5778 - Tishri 5779                 |                                      |                                   |                  |          |        | SEPTEMBER 2018 |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------|----------|--------|----------------|
| SUNDAY                                  | MONDAY                               | TUESDAY                           | WEDNESDAY        | THURSDAY | FRIDAY | SATURDAY       |
|                                         |                                      |                                   |                  |          |        | 1              |
| 2                                       | 3<br>Labor Day                       | 4                                 | 5                | 6        | 7      | 8              |
| 9<br>Erev Rosh Hashanah                 | 10<br>Tishri 1 5779<br>Rosh Hashanah | 11<br>Rosh Hashanah<br>Second Day | 12               | 13       | 14     | 15             |
| 16                                      | 17                                   | 18<br>Erev Yom Kippur             | 19<br>Yom Kippur | 20       | 21     | 22             |
| 23<br>Erev Succoth<br>Hoshana Rabbah 30 | 24<br>Succoth 1st Day                | 25<br>Succoth 2nd Day             | 26               | 27       | 28     | 29             |





A portrait of Heinrich Heine (1797-1856), a seminal figure of the Jewish enlightenment.

When Hitler came to power in 1933, the Jewish population in Germany was about 570,000 out of a total German population of 67 million. By that time, German Jews, while cognizant of their religion, culture and history, had to a considerable degree become incorporated into the larger German community. This had its roots in the "Jewish enlightenment" which began in the latter part of the 18th century. During that time official discrimination against Jews diminished, opening up possibilities for economic, social and cultural integration.

Aspects of that included the deep respect which many Jews held for Germany's great authors such as Goethe and Schiller, for German musicians and artists, and for the German language. The German Jewish writer Heinrich Heine wrote that the German language was "our most sacred possession... a fatherland even for him who is denied one by malice and by folly."

| Tishri - Heshvan 5779 |                      |                    |                 |          |        |          |
|-----------------------|----------------------|--------------------|-----------------|----------|--------|----------|
| SUNDAY                | MONDAY               | TUESDAY            | WEDNESDAY       | THURSDAY | FRIDAY | SATURDAY |
|                       | 1<br>Shemini Atzeret | 2<br>Simchat Torah | 3               | 4        | 5      | 6        |
| 7                     | 8<br>Columbus Day    | 9                  | 10<br>Heshvan 1 | 11       | 12     | 13       |
| 14                    | 15                   | 16                 | 17              | 18       | 19     | 20       |
| 21                    | 22                   | 23                 | 24              | 25       | 26     | 27       |
| 28                    | 29                   | 30                 | 31              |          |        |          |



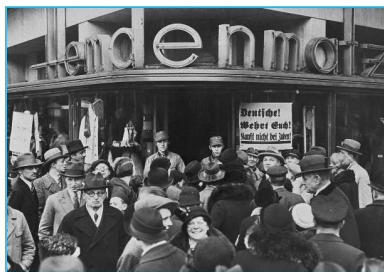
German Jewish soldiers holding a Hannukah celebration in Poland in 1916.

It is estimated that 100,000 Jews served in the German military during World War I, of whom some 12,000 were killed. (Jews could become officers in the reserve, but not the regular army.) In the postwar period, which was known as the Weimar Republic, Jews rose to unprecedented levels of political, economic and artistic influence. Among the best known were Albert Einstein, Franz Kafka, Arnold Schoenberg, Kurt Weill, Erich Fromm and Herbert Marcuse.

As a group, Jews were well off compared to the rest of the German population. It has been reported that 61% of German Jews were engaged in trade and commerce compared with 19% of the general German population. Only 9% of Jews called themselves workers, compared to 46% for Germans as a whole.

During much of the 1920s, German anti-Semitism was at a relatively low ebb, but after the onset of the Great Depression and the start of the Nazis' rise to power, anti-Semitism began to increase. In Germany's 1928 elections, Nazis won only 3% of the vote, but that grew to 18% in 1930 and 37% in 1932.

| Heshvan - Kislev 5779   |        |         |           |                    |               |          |
|-------------------------|--------|---------|-----------|--------------------|---------------|----------|
| SUNDAY                  | MONDAY | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY           | FRIDAY        | SATURDAY |
|                         |        |         |           | 1                  | 2             | 3        |
| 4<br>Daylight Time Ends | 5      | 6       | 7         | 8                  | 9<br>Kislev 1 | 10       |
| 11                      | 12     | 13      | 14        | 15                 | 16            | 17       |
| 18                      | 19     | 20      | 21        | 22                 | 23            | 24       |
| 25                      | 26     | 27      | 28        | 29<br>Thanksgiving | 30            |          |



Outside a Jewish-owned store on April 1, 1933. The sign says "Germans! Protect yourselves! Do not buy from Jews!"

Adolf Hitler became German chancellor on January 30, 1933, and quickly set about consolidating power. The Nazis lost no time taking action against Jews. There were acts of violence against individual Jews almost immediately. On April 1, 1933, Nazi leaders, directed by Hitler, organized a one-day nationwide boycott of Jewish-owned businesses. Storm troopers painted Stars of David in yellow on windows and doors and affixed signs telling the public not to patronize those businesses.

There was violence against individual Jews and damage to property, with only minimal intervention by uniformed authorities.

Some non-Jews defied the boycott, and others made a point of calling on Jewish friends. But the direction things were taking was clear. On April 7, a law was passed limiting participation in the civil service to "Aryans," meaning that Jews were not allowed to hold government positions or to be teachers or judges.

| Kislev - Tevet 5779                    |                      |               |           |          |        |          |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------|---------------|-----------|----------|--------|----------|
| SUNDAY                                 | MONDAY               | TUESDAY       | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY | FRIDAY | SATURDAY |
|                                        |                      |               |           |          |        | 1        |
| 2<br>Hanukkah First Candle             | 3                    | 4             | 5         | 6        | 7      | 8        |
| 9<br>Tevet 1<br>Hanukkah Eighth Candle | 10                   | 11            | 12        | 13       | 14     | 15       |
| 16                                     | 17                   | 18            | 19        | 20       | 21     | 22       |
| 23                                     | 24                   | 25            | 26        | 27       | 28     | 29       |
| 30                                     | 31<br>New Year's Eve | Christmas Day |           |          |        |          |



Hella Hammelbacher's German passport, issued in 1939, showing "Sara" as her middle name.

In early 1937, Jews were not allowed to work in a host of professions. And in 1938, the pace accelerated further. Jews were forced to sell their businesses, usually at a fraction of their worth. Lawyers, doctors and nurses were barred from practicing. Jewish men were required to take the middle name "Israel" and women the middle name "Sara," and Jewish passports were stamped with a large "J."

The ensuing years saw a continual tightening of the vise on Jews. The Dachau concentration camp opened in 1933, followed soon after by Buchenwald, Sachsenhausen and Ravensbrück. Jews were successively banned from owning land and serving in the army. The notorious Nuremberg Laws of 1935 denied German citizenship to Jews, saying they were merely "subjects of the state," and also forbade marriage or sexual relations between Jews and other Germans. There were complex rules established for determining who was a Jew.



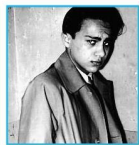
Jews seeking to emigrate, in the Relief Organization of German Jews in Berlin, 1935.

In the years immediately prior to 1930, there was little Jewish emigration from Germany, but especially after 1933, many German Jews responded to the increasing persecution by leaving. Some left as early as 1933, and the Nuremberg laws of 1935 were a further trigger. The tightening of restrictions during 1938 prompted still more Jews to leave, especially as many could no longer earn a living. And Kristallnacht, in November 1938, was powerful and unambiguous evidence of the hopelessness of the situation; it created a sense of extreme urgency among those Jews who remained.

Until then, many Jews were reluctant to leave. Many were prosperous, had families and businesses, were culturally assimilated, and

believed that Nazism was a temporary reaction that would "blow over." The prospect of starting over without resources in a new country was daunting.

Emigration was also greatly hindered by the reluctance of other countries to accept German Jews. The United States had a quota system in place that was not expanded, and many other countries in South America and Africa tightened their immigration policies. The 32-country conference held in Évian, France in July 1938 to discuss the refugee issue produced no practical result.



Herschel Grynszpan. After the assassination he was arrested in Paris, and he eventually was sent to the Sachsenhausen concentration camp. His subsequent fate is not known; in all likelihood he did not survive the war.

Josef Goebbels, the Nazi Minister of Propaganda, was an early follower of Hitler who eventually assumed a central role in planning anti-Semitic disinformation and, later, actions against the Jews. He had been looking for an excuse to begin a pogrom against Germany's Jews, and was provided one on November 7, 1938 when a seventeen-year-old Jewish boy named Herschel Grynszpan critically wounded an official at the German embassy in Paris.

Grynszpan was retaliating for the seizure of his family's property in Hanover, Germany, and their subsequent expulsion to the Polish border along with some 17,000 other Jews, of whom most were not allowed entry into Poland and who remained in camps at the border.

The German diplomat died of his wounds the afternoon of November 9. Led by Goebbels, with Hitler's knowledge and assent, the Nazis claimed that the killing was the fault of "world Jewry" and unleashed the killings, beatings, arrests and massive destruction that came to be known as Kristallnacht.

These events actually began on November 8, and accelerated the night of November 9 and the day of November 10, with sporadic incidents over the following days.

While the Nazis claimed that the events of Kristallnacht were spontaneous, they were nothing of the kind. It was carefully planned by the Nazis (with details left to local leaders) and executed by storm troopers, SS men, Gestapo and Hitler Youth. As Jewish prisoners were paraded through the streets, some Germans cheered or participated in looting after stores were smashed, while others looked on passively.

Tevet - Shevat 5779

JANUARY 2019

| SUNDAY | MONDAY                                              | TUESDAY                 | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY | FRIDAY | SATURDAY |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|-----------|----------|--------|----------|
|        |                                                     | 1<br><br>New Year's Day | 2         | 3        | 4      | 5        |
| 6      | 7<br><br>Shevat 1                                   | 8                       | 9         | 10       | 11     | 12       |
| 13     | 14                                                  | 15                      | 16        | 17       | 18     | 19       |
| 20     | 21<br><br>Tu B'Shevat<br>Martin Luther King Jr. Day | 22                      | 23        | 24       | 25     | 26       |
| 27     | 28                                                  | 29                      | 30        | 31       |        |          |

Shevat - Adar I 5779

FEBRUARY 2019

| SUNDAY | MONDAY               | TUESDAY                  | WEDNESDAY     | THURSDAY              | FRIDAY                      | SATURDAY |
|--------|----------------------|--------------------------|---------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------|----------|
|        |                      |                          |               |                       | 1                           | 2        |
| 3      | 4                    | 5                        | 6<br>Adar I 1 | 7                     | 8                           | 9        |
| 10     | 11                   | 12<br>Lincoln's Birthday | 13            | 14<br>Valentine's Day | 15                          | 16       |
| 17     | 18<br>Presidents Day | 19                       | 20            | 21                    | 22<br>Washington's Birthday | 23       |
| 24     | 25                   | 26                       | 27            | 28                    |                             |          |

Adar I - Adar II 5779

MARCH 2019

| SUNDAY               | MONDAY | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY  | THURSDAY | FRIDAY    | SATURDAY |
|----------------------|--------|---------|------------|----------|-----------|----------|
|                      |        |         |            |          | 1         | 2        |
| 3                    | 4      | 5       | 6          | 7        | 8         | 9        |
|                      |        |         |            |          | Adar II 1 |          |
| 10                   | 11     | 12      | 13         | 14       | 15        | 16       |
| Daylight Time Begins |        |         |            |          |           |          |
| 17                   | 18     | 19      | 20         | 21       | 22        | 23       |
|                      |        |         | Erev Purim | Purim    |           |          |
| 24                   | 25     | 26      | 27         | 28       | 29        | 30       |
| 31                   |        |         |            |          |           |          |



Jewish prisoners marched through the streets of Baden-Baden on November 10, 1938.

During the Kristallnacht pogrom, some 30,000 Jews were sent to concentration camps, most to Dachau and others to Buchenwald and Sachsenhausen. Many of them died from beatings, starvation and lack of medical care at the camps.

The toll from Kristallnacht will never be known with certainty. In all likelihood, more than 2,000 died as an immediate result. Initial estimates were that 91 Jews were killed November 9-10. But that vastly understates the actual casualties. Some died from their wounds in the ensuing days, and many others — probably hundreds — committed suicide after seeing loved ones taken away or losing their possessions. There were rapes as well.

| Adar II - Nisan 5779 |        |         |           |          |                     | APRIL 2019             |
|----------------------|--------|---------|-----------|----------|---------------------|------------------------|
| SUNDAY               | MONDAY | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY | FRIDAY              | SATURDAY               |
|                      | 1      | 2       | 3         | 4        | 5                   | 6<br>Nisan 1           |
| 7                    | 8      | 9       | 10        | 11       | 12                  | 13                     |
| 14                   | 15     | 16      | 17        | 18       | 19<br>Erev Passover | 20<br>Passover 1st Day |
| 21<br>Easter Sunday  | 22     | 23      | 24        | 25       | 26                  | 27<br>Passover 8th Day |
| 28                   | 29     | 30      |           |          |                     |                        |



A Jewish-owned lighting store in Berlin, November 10, 1938.

By the time of Kristallnacht, most Jewish-owned shops in Germany had already been transferred to non-Jewish owners or closed, but some 9,000 shops still remained in Jewish hands. Approximately 7,500 of them were smashed, vandalized, looted and sometimes burned during Kristallnacht.

German fire departments and police were ordered not to extinguish fires unless the fires threatened to consume Aryan-owned property.

Jews who had already lost almost everything as their property was damaged or destroyed were subsequently made to pay "reparations" to cover the cost of the cleanup — a vast sum of money (the equivalent of hundreds of millions of dollars) that took away much of what remained of their savings. Kristallnacht plunged many Jewish families into extreme poverty, making them search frantically for even the most basic necessities.

| Nisan - Iyar 5779  |              |         |           |                              |        | MAY 2019 |
|--------------------|--------------|---------|-----------|------------------------------|--------|----------|
| SUNDAY             | MONDAY       | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY                     | FRIDAY | SATURDAY |
|                    |              |         | 1         | 2<br>Yom Hashoah             | 3      | 4        |
| 5                  | 6<br>Iyar 1  | 7       | 8         | 9<br>Israel Independence Day | 10     | 11       |
| 12                 | 13           | 14      | 15        | 16                           | 17     | 18       |
| 19<br>Mother's Day | 20           | 21      | 22        | 23                           | 24     | 25       |
| 26                 | 27           | 28      | 29        | 30<br>Lag B'Omer             | 31     |          |
|                    | Memorial Day |         |           |                              |        |          |



The synagogue in Baden-Baden on November 10, 1938.

A key part of the Nazi attack on everything Jewish during Kristallnacht was the burning and desecration of synagogues. Almost 1,700 synagogues were ransacked, and 267 set on fire.

Many of those synagogues were magnificent buildings, with striking architecture in a variety of styles (notably neo-Islamic, German Romanesque and contemporary). Some had served their communities for more than a hundred years. They were repositories for Torahs and

religious artifacts, and they were centers of learning and social hubs for their communities. On Kristallnacht, most of them were destroyed.

Many Jewish cemeteries were also desecrated, with tombstones uprooted and smashed.

The Blue Card Calendar for 5769 showed some of the "virtual reconstructions" of synagogues done by students and professors at the University of Darmstadt, Germany. Visit <http://bit.ly/virtual-reconstruction> to see some of those destroyed synagogues painstakingly brought back to life.

| Iyar - Sivan 5779    |                       |              |           |          |        | JUNE 2019         |
|----------------------|-----------------------|--------------|-----------|----------|--------|-------------------|
| SUNDAY               | MONDAY                | TUESDAY      | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY | FRIDAY | SATURDAY          |
|                      |                       |              |           |          |        | 1                 |
| 2                    | 3                     | 4<br>Sivan 1 | 5         | 6        | 7      | 8<br>Erev Shavuot |
| 9<br>Shavuot 1st Day | 10<br>Shavuot 2nd Day | 11           | 12        | 13       | 14     | 15                |
| 16                   | 17                    | 18           | 19        | 20       | 21     | 22                |
| 23<br>Father's Day   | 24                    | 25           | 26        | 27       | 28     | 29                |
| 30                   |                       |              |           |          |        |                   |





Dr. Ruth Westheimer at the 2013 Annual Blue Card Benefit Dinner.

Personal accounts of Kristallnacht and its aftermath can be powerful in conveying the terror Jews felt in those days and the desperate circumstances they were forced into. One person of note who has recounted her experiences is Dr. Ruth Westheimer, the renowned sex therapist (and longtime friend of The Blue Card).

In a 2016 interview with the Washington Post, Dr. Westheimer told some of her story (<http://bit.ly/ruthw>). Born Karola Ruth Siegel, she was ten years old at the time of Kristallnacht. A week after Kristallnacht, Nazis came to their apartment in Frankfurt and arrested her father, sending him to a concentration camp. Just before he boarded the truck that took him away, he smiled at Ruth. They never saw each other again.

A few weeks later, the family received a postcard from her father, directing that Ruth board a *Kindertransport*. (The *Kindertransport* programs were directed by Jewish organizations in Germany, sending children under the age of 17 to safe countries.) In January

1939, with other children she boarded a train to Switzerland, where for two years she lived in an orphanage. She was able to correspond with her parents, who were in Poland by that time, but after that there was no more communication from them.

Dr. Westheimer said in the interview: "I lived, while 1½ million Jewish children died. So I have an obligation to repair the world."

| Sivan - Tammuz 5779 |        |         |           |                                   |        |          |
|---------------------|--------|---------|-----------|-----------------------------------|--------|----------|
| SUNDAY              | MONDAY | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY                          | FRIDAY | SATURDAY |
|                     | 1      | 2       | 3         | 4<br>Tammuz 1<br>Independence Day | 5      | 6        |
| 7                   | 8      | 9       | 10        | 11                                | 12     | 13       |
| 14                  | 15     | 16      | 17        | 18                                | 19     | 20       |
| 21                  | 22     | 23      | 24        | 25                                | 26     | 27       |
| 28                  | 29     | 30      | 31        |                                   |        |          |



Frank Harris in the U.S. Army in 1943.

Another Blue Card friend of long standing was the late Frank Harris, who passed away in 2017 at the age of 94. Born Franz Hess in 1922, he grew up in Fuerth. A biography on the extraordinary Rijo Research site (<http://bit.ly/frankharris>) recounts some of Frank's history.

At 3:00 a.m. on November 10, brownshirts forced their way into the Hesses' apartment. Along with many other Jews, they dressed hurriedly and were herded into the courtyard of a Jewish school, then marched through the streets of Fuerth as the local population shouted abuse. After a lecture on the evils of Judaism, women and children under the age of 16 were released — Frank qualified for release because he was 15 years and 11 months old. Frank's father, along with many other Jewish men, was taken to Dachau. Frank's mother was later able to obtain Frank's father's freedom by selling the family business for the equivalent of \$10, but Frank's father never recovered in spirit.

With many hardships along the way, including the bombing of a hotel where they were staying, the family made its way to the Netherlands, England and finally the U.S. In 1943, Frank volunteered for the U.S. Army. His later career was in food service, where he was instrumental in establishing school lunch programs and in promoting children's nutrition. And he established the Nuremberg-Fuerth Survivors Group, bringing together survivors and their descendants, five generations in all. In massive annual newsletters and at a series of conferences, Frank helped to create lasting bonds among many people, some of whom were reunited after decades apart. Frank's luminous personality and capacity for friendship are remembered by the many people who knew him.

| Tammuz - Av 5779 |        |         |           |          |           |          |
|------------------|--------|---------|-----------|----------|-----------|----------|
| SUNDAY           | MONDAY | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY | FRIDAY    | SATURDAY |
|                  |        |         |           | 1        | 2<br>Av 1 | 3        |
| 4                | 5      | 6       | 7         | 8        | 9         | 10       |
| 11               | 12     | 13      | 14        | 15       | 16        | 17       |
| Tisha B'Av       | 18     | 19      | 20        | 21       | 22        | 23       |
|                  |        |         |           |          |           | 24       |
| 25               | 26     | 27      | 28        | 29       | 30        | 31       |



Jewish children from Austria arriving in London in 1939.

The time between Kristallnacht and the German invasion of Poland on September 1, 1939 was filled with further disasters for Germany's Jews.

On November 12, 1938, Goebbels announced that all remaining Jewish shops would be transferred to non-Jews in the coming months, and that Jews could not practice trades or sell any kinds of goods or services. Additional decrees made it all but impossible for Jews to work or own property, and those who did have businesses or real estate were forced to part with their property for a minuscule fraction of its worth.

In December, Jewish agencies began the *Kindertransport* programs, which sent between 9,000 and 10,000 Jewish children without their parents to other countries — most to the United Kingdom. Like Dr. Ruth Westheimer, most never saw their parents again.

Meanwhile, those German Jews who remained searched desperately for ways to leave, hindered by their inability to pay the emigration taxes and by the refusal of other countries to accept refugees in sufficient numbers. It is estimated that by the end of 1939, about 200,000 Jews remained in Germany. By 1940, escape routes were effectively closed.

| Elul 5779 - Tishri 5780  |                                      |         |           |          |        |          |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------|---------|-----------|----------|--------|----------|
| SUNDAY                   | MONDAY                               | TUESDAY | WEDNESDAY | THURSDAY | FRIDAY | SATURDAY |
| 1<br>Elul 1              | 2<br>Labor Day                       | 3       | 4         | 5        | 6      | 7        |
| 8                        | 9                                    | 10      | 11        | 12       | 13     | 14       |
| 15                       | 16                                   | 17      | 18        | 19       | 20     | 21       |
| 22                       | 23                                   | 24      | 25        | 26       | 27     | 28       |
| 29<br>Erev Rosh Hashanah | 30<br>Tishri 1 5780<br>Rosh Hashanah |         |           |          |        |          |



The front page of the New York Times on November 11, 1938.

favor loosening U.S. immigration restrictions, and efforts to enact a bill to take in more German children failed to go anywhere in Congress.

The well-known voyage of the *St. Louis*, where more than 900 passengers sailed from Hamburg as far as Havana and were denied entry to both Cuba and the U.S., provides only the best-known example of the appalling effects of the restrictive immigration policies that prevailed.

We can only wonder how many lives might have been saved had the doors to immigration been opened wider. As bad as conditions for European Jews were in the wake of Kristallnacht, things were about to get much worse.

Contrary to what many people believe, the events of Kristallnacht were widely reported and discussed in the U.S. and elsewhere. There was broad recognition of the danger to German Jews, and religious leaders warned of the threats of anti-Semitism and of religious prejudice more generally. There was an anti-Nazi demonstration in New York. But for the most part these words did not lead to action to take in more refugees. The U.S. had a strict quota system in place, and although President Franklin Roosevelt extended the visas of the German Jewish refugees already in the U.S., he also said that liberalizing the quotas was “not in contemplation.” Public opinion did not

| Tishri - Heshvan 5780 |                                       |                                  |                 |          |        |          |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------|----------|--------|----------|
| OCTOBER 2019          |                                       |                                  |                 |          |        |          |
| SUNDAY                | MONDAY                                | TUESDAY                          | WEDNESDAY       | THURSDAY | FRIDAY | SATURDAY |
|                       |                                       | 1<br>Rosh Hashanah<br>Second Day | 2               | 3        | 4      | 5        |
| 6                     | 7                                     | 8<br>Erev Yom Kippur             | 9<br>Yom Kippur | 10       | 11     | 12       |
| 13<br>Erev Succoth    | 14<br>Succoth 1st Day<br>Columbus Day | 15<br>Succoth 2nd Day            | 16              | 17       | 18     | 19       |
| 20<br>Hoshana Rabba   | 21<br>Shemini Atzeret                 | 22<br>Simchat Torah              | 23              | 24       | 25     | 26       |
| 27                    | 28                                    | 29                               | 30<br>Heshvan 1 | 31       |        |          |



Established in Germany in 1934, The Blue Card's sole purpose was to provide financial assistance to Jews fleeing from that country's growing persecution. It was re-established in the United States in 1939, to continue aiding refugees escaping from the Nazi horror. Today, it is the only organization in the United States whose sole mission is to aid needy Holocaust survivors by providing cash assistance.

The Blue Card offers its invaluable help to Holocaust survivors through a variety of vital programs.

**Description of The Blue Card's Programs**

**I. Claims Conference Emergency Cash Assistance Program – One time grant assistance for emergency needs including:**

- Housing and related costs, such as late payments to prevent eviction or homelessness or shut-off of utilities

- Emergency relocation
- Food purchases
- Medical and dental care, including medical equipment, not otherwise covered by insurance
- Essential clothing and footwear
- Purchase and repair of essential major and minor appliances

**2. Claims Conference In-Home Care Services**

- Health service provided in the survivors' homes to promote, maintain, or restore health or lessen the effects of illness and disability. The purpose of the program is to ensure safe and independent living.
- Claims Conference In-Home Care Service Program for underserved survivors, meaning specifically those residing in remote areas and who are outside of the catchment areas of Claims Conference grantees.
- The Emergency Cash Assistance Program and the In-Home Care Services Program is funded by The Conference on Jewish Material Claims Against Germany.

**3. Emergency Prevention Programs:**

- Monthly Stipend - supports the most poverty-stricken survivors with monthly checks.
- Telephone Emergency Response System - provides the system to Holocaust survivors who do not have the financial resources to pay for installation, service, and maintenance.

**4. Health and Wellbeing Programs:**

- Fighting Cancer Together - offers aid to survivors battling cancer. Assistance is available for transportation to appointments, medical co-pays, nutrition and emotional support.
- Vitamins - provides survivors with multivitamins, minerals, and supplements, and liquid meals.
- Jewish Holiday - provides financial support for the High Holidays, Hanukkah and for Passover, giving survivors the financial means to have a happier holiday season.
- Mazel Tov Birthday - provides survivors with a card on their birthday. Receiving a birthday card means a great deal to survivors who lost their entire families during the war.

- Summer Vacation - Survivors are provided with handicapped-accessible accommodations, transportation, scheduled meals, and a well-planned itinerary, making the program structured, safe, and group-oriented.
- Bring a Smile - provides additional support for terminally ill Holocaust survivors. The program essentially grants survivors their final wish.

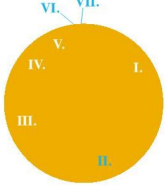
**5. Educational and Outreach Programs:**

- Person-Centered, Trauma-Informed Training for Dental and Medical professionals working with Holocaust survivors – provides sensitivity training to medical and dental profession working with Holocaust survivors.
- Nutrition Guidance - Educates Survivors on proper nutrition.
- Hospital Visitation - offers volunteer visits to hospitalized Holocaust survivors who need guidance and emotional support.

In 2017, The Blue Card distributed \$3,406,854 to destitute Holocaust survivors in the United States; below is the breakdown of that number.

|                                          |                    |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| I. Homecare Program                      | \$1,280,184        |
| II. Emergency Cash Assistance Program    | \$805,233          |
| III. Monthly Assistance Program          | \$650,000          |
| IV. Telephone Emergency Response Program | \$352,328          |
| V. Jewish Holiday Program                | \$159,109          |
| VI. Mazel Tov Birthday Program           | \$100,000          |
| VII. Summer Vacation Program             | \$60,000           |
| <b>Total</b>                             | <b>\$3,406,854</b> |

The Blue Card's Clients Across the United States





# THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR

5779

